

Read This Before Running the Backend

JWT local setup is required — skipping this causes 500 errors on every endpoint

Why this matters

The backend signs and validates JWT tokens using **Jwt:Key** and **Jwt:Issuer** from configuration (see **Program.cs** and **Utils/CryptService.cs**). These values are **not** committed to **appsettings.json** — each developer sets them locally with **dotnet user-secrets**.

If they are not set, **Jwt:Key** is **null**, and **Encoding.UTF8.GetBytes(...)** throws — every endpoint, including **/games**, returns **500**.

Important: **Jwt:Key** must be at least 32 characters long. A shorter key fails with **IDX10720** when generating a token.

Setup (Windows / macOS / Linux)

1. Open the terminal.

2. Navigate to the backend project directory:

```
cd PSI-Arcade/Backend
```

3. Initialize user secrets for the project (safe to run even if already initialized):

```
dotnet user-secrets init
```

4. Set the JWT key (32+ characters):

```
dotnet user-secrets set "Jwt:Key" "your-local-development-secret-key-32chars+"
```

5. Set the JWT issuer:

```
dotnet user-secrets set "Jwt:Issuer" "SportMatch.API"
```

6. Verify the values were saved:

```
dotnet user-secrets list
```

Note: the project already has a **UserSecretsId** set in **SportMatch.API.csproj**, so **dotnet user-secrets init** will just report it is already initialized — it is included above as a no-op safety step in case that ever changes.